

Jin Saeki Ko

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EDUCATION

California Polytechnic State University San Luis Obispo

Bachelor of Science, Microbiology
GPA: 3.73

Expected graduation: June 2027

RESEARCH

Microbiology Undergraduate Researcher

Feb 2024 - Present

- Dr. Alejandra Yep's Lab; inhibiting iron acquisition in uropathogenic *Escherichia coli* as a potential treatment option for UTIs; more details [here](#)
- Dr. Alejandra Yep's Lab; exploring the role of surfactants in swarming motility; more details [here](#)
- Individual Project; contributing to open source software using python to create an automated plate measuring software

Chemistry Undergraduate Researcher

Sep 2025 - Present

- Dr. Corrine Lehr's Lab; came up with a protocol using Atomic Absorption Spectroscopy to measure intracellular iron in isogenic strains of *Escherichia coli*; more details [here](#)

CONFERENCE

American Society for Microbiology 2025

June 2025

- Poster Presentation; more details [here](#)

CSU BIOTECH Symposium

Jan 2026

- Poster Presentation

West Coast Biological Sciences Undergraduate Research Conference

April 2025

- Poster Presentation

BCSM Student Research Conference

May 2024, 2025, 2026

- Poster Presentation for College-wide conference

EXPERIENCE

Clinical Assistant

Aug 2024 - Present

- Collaborating with clinic staff to provide comprehensive healthcare services for Cal Poly students through the campus health center
- Taking vitals, rooming patients, collecting urine samples, and cleaning exam rooms

Dignity Health Physician Mentorship Program

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Shadowed physicians from pediatrics, nephrology, neonatology, cardiology, anesthesiology, and orthopedic surgery for 8 weeks, gaining insight into a myriad of medical disciplines

Department of Chemistry and Biochemistry Learning Assistant

Jan 2024 - June 2024

- Worked with faculty to facilitate student discussion and problem solving
- Received training in working with students and significant experience in teaching in a college classroom

LEADERSHIP

ASI University Student Governor

May 2024 - June 2025

- One of eight members working for *Associated Students Inc.* representing the university student body on the University Union Advisory Board

- Voting on policy for ASI managed facilities

Bailey College of Science and Mathematics Ambassador

Nov 2023 - Present

- Educating prospective students and guardians about college's myriad opportunities through leading tours across campus
- Representing Cal Poly's College of Science and Mathematics through various university-wide outreach events

University Committee for Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

Nov 2023 - June 2024

- Partaking in student panels for prospective students to share college equity efforts
- Working with faculty on the academic senate to create an inclusive and equitable college culture by addressing policies and practices that are barriers to student success
- Planning university-wide DEI related events

VOLUNTEERING

Hospice San Luis Obispo County In-Home Hospice Volunteer

Oct 2023 - Present

- Received training in working with the elderly and people with cognitive disorders to aid clients in end-of-life journey
- Visiting client homes biweekly to provide practical and emotional support

Restorative Partners San Luis Obispo Volunteer

Aug 2024 - Present

- Received training in practicing restorative justice with the incarcerated youth at juvenile hall
- Engaging in sports and connecting with the youth to offer emotional support
- Currently programming on an online platform for juveniles to share their art with the public

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Frost Fellow

May 2025 - Present

- Scholarship of 10K annually to participate in research for the remainder of undergraduate career
- Scholarship of 4.5K to conduct summer research